



Focus CeBIT

Making Lemonade?



Last year, Samsung unveiled the Q1 Ultra Mobile PC (UMPC), which was widely boo-ed and was generally regarded as one of the biggest lemons of CeBIT 2006. Samsung returned this year with the Q1 Ultra, with some upgrades, support for every wireless broadband protocol imaginable, an unnamed dual-core processor from Intel, and Vista Home Premium, no less. The keyboard isn't on-screen any more; you now have a split QWERTY keyboard on either side of the 7-inch screen. The keys are quite tiny, though—it's highly probable you'd be hitting two, maybe three keys with every stroke of even a non-podgy thumb. To control the mouse, you have a PSP-like analogue nub-type-thing, which is easy to get used to in five minutes or so. Battery life is projected at 3.5 hours—a whole 30 minutes more than last year—but is extendable to seven with an add-on battery pack. The best part, though, is its support for Bluetooth 2.0, Wi-Fi (802.11b/g), HSDPA, and WiBro (the mobile version of WiMax).



What's more, the Q1 Ultra trumps ASUS' UMPCs—the T83 (a 7-inch laptop to the untrained eye) comes with a 1 GHz Via processor and 512 MB of RAM, while the Vista-ready-but-running-XP ASUS R2H comes with a 900 MHz Celeron M and 256 MB of RAM (upgradeable to 768 MB). On the plus side, though, the latter two will last seven hours on a single charge. The battle begins...



TV Off Your USB Stick

This neat little thing from SanDisk will launch in a month or so—it's a 4 GB (or 8 GB, should you be so inclined) USB Flash disk that you can carry your movies around on, and comes with an adapter that you can use to connect it to your TV—either by coaxial or RCA connectors—and view your movies right there! The quality of your viewing experience will greatly depend on the format and compression of the movie, obviously—especially so if you're using an LCD TV. No word on cost, though, and we're told that a high-def version is in the works as well. Of course, a solid-state drive for HD content shouldn't cost the 600-odd dollars their new 32 GB Solid State Disk is going to cost.

For one week every year, the sleepy town of Hannover, Germany, creaks under the weight of the hordes of tradesmen and technology enthusiasts that descend upon it with but one thing in mind—CeBIT. We, too, braved the chilly winds and freezing rain (and they call it summer!) and suppressed our tourist instincts to bring you this report. Though it's lost about half its visitors since 2002, the fair still throbs with life...

DDR3 COMETH!

Intel announced its Bearlake family of Desktop chipsets here—the P35 and G33 will support the DDR3 memory standard, upping the bus speeds to 1333 MHz and consequently offering more memory bandwidth. Partners such as ASUS will ship their P35-based boards for the Core 2 Duo and Core 2 Quad soon. The G33 will launch later this year, and will supposedly be the cutting edge of gaming boards.